Launch Control XL 3 — House Piano Lab (lab/keys)

Seven keyboard sounds, six iconic house riffs, three progressions, over a dry house loop. Pull up one sound at a time, change the riff (column 8, button 1) and hear what the rhythm does.

Classy house is dry: start with every Space at 0. Swing (column 8, knob 1) at 55-60 % gives the MPC feel.

The status box at the bottom right shows sound, riff, progression and chords.

Knob Fader Button unused

Mode 16 — House Piano Lab

	1 Grand, dry	2 M1 style (90s)	3 Rhodes (deep)	4 DX e-piano	5 Organ stab	6 Clavinet	7 Vibraphone	8 Riff + context
Row 1	CC 13 **Brightness** 1.5–14 kHz low-pass.	CC 14 **Brightness** 2–14 kHz low-pass.	CC 15 **Brightness** 800 Hz–9 kHz low-pass: warm ↔ barking.	CC 16 **Brightness** 1.5–12 kHz low-pass.	CC 17 **Brightness** 1–10 kHz low-pass.	CC 18 **Brightness** 1.5–12 kHz low-pass.	CC 19 **Brightness** 1.5–12 kHz low-pass.	CC 20 **Swing** 50 % (straight) ↔ 70 %: the in-between 16ths come late (MPC swing; 55–60 % = classic house).
Row 2	CC 21 **Space** 0 = dry ↔ a room.	CC 22 **Space** 0 = dry ↔ a room.	CC 23 **Space** 0 = dry ↔ a room.	CC 24 **Space** 0 = dry ↔ a room.	CC 25 **Space** 0 = dry ↔ a room.	CC 26 **Space** 0 = dry ↔ a room.	CC 27 **Space** 0 = dry ↔ a room.	CC 28 **Humanize** 0 = every hit equally loud ↔ played by hand (loose velocities).
Row 3	CC 29 **Length** 150 ms–1.5 s: short stabs ↔ ringing.	CC 30 **Length** 120 ms–1 s.	CC 31 **Length** 200 ms–2 s.	CC 32 **Length** 150 ms–1.5 s.	CC 33 **Length** 80–600 ms: organ stabs are short.	CC 34 **Length** 60–500 ms.	CC 35 **Length** 200 ms–2 s.	CC 36 —
Fader Level	CC 5 **Level** the Salamander grand, dry, the low end cut (the bass has it).	CC 6 **Level** the 90s house piano: grand + DX e-piano + a detuned copy, thin and bright, a little saturated.	CC 7 **Level** Rhodes (soundfont): the warm, round keys of deep house.	CC 8 **Level** the FM e-piano of the 80s (DX7 style): glassy, bell-like, very house.	CC 9 **Level** the percussive organ of 90s house: short, clicky stabs.	CC 10 **Level** Clavinet: funky, plucked, for disco and funky house.	CC 11 **Level** vibraphone: soft, jazzy, deep house of the late 80s.	CC 12 **Context** a dry house loop: 909 kick, off-beat hat, clap, shaker, bass on the chord root.
Buttons 1	CC 37 **Solo** only this sound; press again = all.	CC 38 **Solo** only this sound; press again = all.	CC 39 **Solo** only this sound; press again = all.	CC 40 **Solo** only this sound; press again = all.	CC 41 **Solo** only this sound; press again = all.	CC 42 **Solo** only this sound; press again = all.	CC 43 **Solo** only this sound; press again = all.	CC 44 **Riff** stabs, off-beat, call, gospel, throw-in, anthem.
Buttons 2	CC 45 **Octave up** on: top note doubled an octave up.	CC 46 **Organ under** on: a quiet organ layer (M1 feel).	CC 47 **Phaser** on: a slow phaser, the 70s / Larry Heard swirl.	CC 48 **Chorus** on: a detuned copy, wider and shimmering.	CC 49 **Drawbar** on: drawbar organ, rounder, gospel.	CC 50 **Wah** on: an auto-wah on every note.	CC 51 **Marimba** on: marimba instead, woody and dry.	CC 52 **Progression** happy → deep → Italo.

Guide

The sound

The 90s house piano is the Korg M1 “Piano 8”’: a bright, thin, compressed piano, a little chorus, often an organ underneath (column 2 imitates it). Deep house uses Rhodes (3) or the DX e-piano (4); organ stabs (5) are the other 90s classic.

The rhythm

House piano is a drum: short stabs, gaps, hits before the beat (the “push”). 3-3-2 stabs, off-beats, a two-bar call and response, a rolling gospel left hand, one big chord as a throw-in. Held chords for whole bars sound like a pad, not like house.

The chords

7ths and 9ths (Amaj7, F♯m7, Am9, D9), close together around middle C, so the chords move by small steps. Happy = major 7ths. Deep = a minor 9 / dominant 9 vamp (Dorian). Italo = plain triads, big and bright.

What to try

Riff 1 with the M1 sound (2), then the same riff with Rhodes (3): same notes, different decade. Riff 5 (throw-in) shows how much a gap is worth. Then swing up to 58 % and humanize a little.